MASS WORK POINTS OF UNITY



FOR THE PROLIFERATION OF REVOLUTIONARY SCIENCE

As scholar Joshua Moufawad-Paul describes, “without a scientific understanding of social struggle we are incapable of recognizing when and where failed theories manifest.”[1] Our goals, as members of Mass Work, require a truly scientific approach to political struggle, one that examines revolutions and conditions of the present and past to enact one for the future through the lenses of dialectical and historical materialism. It is through revolutionary experimentation with class struggle, deep self-critique, avoidance of dogmatism, and adaptability that we may adjust to the material conditions of capitalism without falling to opportunism.

FOR THE PRIORITIZATION TOWARDS MASS WORK

There are many important areas of struggle on the path toward socialist construction, yet our organization places most of its energy in the electoral and union spheres. This emphasis has led to the growth of some political power but will not produce a socialist future on its own. Mass work is paramount for the organization's growth, and it will allow us to organize the masses

outside of the traditional workplace. By organizing the broadest segment of the masses, we expand the reach of socialist political power and revolutionary consciousness. Mass work keeps the organization connected to the masses by challenging opportunism in praxis. By submerging our organization with the masses we further our understanding of their struggle and how to lead the broadest section toward a socialist future. We do this by gathering the ideas and needs of the masses, consolidating these ideas developing a rearticulation through revolutionary theory of how to enact them, and then returning to the masses with our articulations to ensure their acceptance.

We have already seen the embryonic stages of such a program in TCDSA through the Environmental Justice, Housing, and Street Corps branches. All of these are heavily invested in raising the conditions of entire segments of the Twin Cities, whether that is shutting down plants that cause health issues in working-class neighborhoods, organizing against slumlords, or talking to and helping our unhoused and housed neighbors. If we are to expand our ranks into the deepest sections of the proletariat and organize a true mass party, it is imperative that TCDSA put its full weight onto these initiatives and more like them.

We must reject opportunism and economism within electoral and labor organizing respectively, and anchor the labor and electoral struggle to a principled mass communist movement. We must combat the capitulation to capital brought about by an over-dedication to short-term electoral concessions. Similarly, we must combat efforts in the labor sphere to limit our struggle solely to fight for material gains and the protection of the labor aristocracy. We must instead fight for a labor and electoral strategy which centers revolutionary anti-capitalist struggle and international liberation of all oppressed peoples.

FOR THE DEMOCRATIC RESTRUCTURING OF TCDSA

The efforts of our comrades in this chapter reflect the care and dedication found in the histories of all those who struggle for the end of domination, but we recognize effort alone is not a measure of virtue. Rather, there must be a conjunction of effort and intentional collective development. We want to reorient our chapter toward mass work in our organizational structure, which is accomplished through developing internal communication and coordination across our sites of struggle and prioritizing a geographically localized strategy for reaching the masses. Coordinating our points of struggle ensures the success of our mass work and brings people into the movement at the points they are most impacted. We seek to establish a more straightforward and effective chapter structure to focus our energies in a coordinated manner. Through these changes, we seek to push against siloization and encourage cooperation amongst the many different areas of struggle in which our chapter involves itself.

FOR A BREAK FROM BOURGEOIS PARTIES

We advocate for the movement away from participation in bourgeois parties that do not truly stand for the working class, and do not align with our ultimate goal to upend the capitalist system. Utilization of the ballot box may serve a role in advertising an alternative vision to business-as-usual politics within this country, through roles in governance and opposition. This political approach is something that the proletariat widely craves, across many social strata, and must be pursued. We must acknowledge that the working class still largely views "politics" as what happens in the voting booth, and not what happens in our daily lives, in the streets, and within our localized struggles. There is organizational power and familiarity in the Party structure, but it must be a Party made up of the working class, organized towards solely working class interests at a local, national, and international level. This Party must address current material needs and conditions while connecting them to a wider vision of and struggle toward a communist future. This must be an independent grassroots Party, and we recognize the immediate need to organize for an explicit break from the Democratic Party.

FOR SELF-DETERMINATION

We acknowledge the necessity of anti-colonial foundations to political organizing, especially as we conduct our work upon the violently colonized land of Turtle Island—a colonization that is ongoing. We are for the re-building of the land, and everything stolen from the First Nations: "land, language, ceremony, food, education, housing, healthcare governance, medicines, and kinship."[2]

We know that the world we strive to build includes Black reparations, to help repair intergenerational harm spiraling from the labor that was forced to build this nation, and that this is deeply interconnected to the fight for self-determination. This struggle demands that we are educated on, and fight for the self-determination of Indigenous peoples across the world. It demands we know the historical harm we cause, as citizens of the capitalist empire, in systemically suppressing liberation struggles around the globe. We must resist the continuation of colonization and imperialism at all levels, at every turn.

FOR THE LIBERATION FROM ALL SOCIAL ILLS

We understand that all forms of oppression inherently spring from the inequalities that class society and its contradictions exacerbate. To discount these oppressions–including but not limited to racism, sexism, homophobia, transphobia, and ableism–is to discount the current terrain upon which we organize and discount the superstructure through which we view the world. It is essential to address the ways those forms of oppression affect both the base and superstructure of contradictions as it exists in our world today: colonialism, imperialism, patriarchy, and other constructions that have historically served as arms of the bourgeois class, and therefore the capitalist state.

FOR THE ELIMINATION OF MALE CHAUVINISM & WHITE CHAUVINISM

As communists whose assumed cannon is often comprised of written theory that is overwhelmingly white and male, we recognize the necessity to study closely not only the liberation struggles of various oppressed peoples outside of the Eurocentric sphere of politics, but also the ways in which constructions of racism and sexism have deeply ingrained themselves unconsciously in the human psyche, and how this presents in our current movement spaces. As we remain committed to (re)creating a society without these divides, we must therefore pursue these dynamics within our organizing; structurally, culturally, and interpersonally. We must prioritize connecting struggles for reproductive freedoms and women's liberation to the underlying class struggle. We must challenge reflections of male supremacy within our everyday organizing; for example, the relegation of female comrades to do social reproductive labor such as childcare, conflict resolution, note-taking, and cleaning of shared spaces.

We must eliminate white chauvinism as it exists in all forms, from overt racism to paternalism to outright exclusion. Acknowledgment of these forms of harm can not be a replacement for the material and historical contexts that reproduce this dynamic even among anti-racists, in order to even begin to address the historical harms to groups throughout “America’s” history, as well as the history of the world. We must push back against reflections of white supremacist culture within our organizing, especially in the localized context of the so-called United States, whose foundations relied upon the violent enslavement of those deemed expendable in the pursuit of capital. This violence and its connections to capital do not guarantee that anticapitalist theory is always antiracist and the end of capitalism will end the pattern of racial oppression. The exclusion of Black, Indigenous, and many other rich histories of working-class resistance is a severe detriment to the Communist movement as it stands today, and we seek to address this at all levels of organizing. This is paramount for our work to avoid hypocrisy and be successful in our aim for liberation.

FOR DEGROWTH

We must move beyond capitalistic notions of infinite economic growth with finite resources. Capitalism produces alienation, not only of man from his labor, but also of man from nature. We must antagonize the western hope of a “green” capitalist system without major social and cultural change. There is an inherent metabolic rift in the rate of consumption of capital and the rate of replenishment of nature. Degrowth communism attempts to address this by a far-reaching realignment of production. While the Western Communist tradition often limits dialectics to society, we assert that Nature is also a primary consideration of any political or economic structure. Keeping our sights on degrowth-informed communism is the key to addressing the contradiction between capital and Nature. We recognize the need to struggle against “ecological” visions containing infinite economic growth,, and focus our energy on the struggles that will let us live on an inhabitable Earth by 2100.

Notes

1. See *The Communist Necessity: A Prolegomena To Any Future Radical Theory* by J. Moufawad-Paul
2. https://landback.org/manifesto/